

FYP Dissertation Guidance and Submission Instructions 2025-2026

Overview

Key Points

- Submit via Moodle
 - Dissertation - <https://moodle.nottingham.ac.uk/mod/turnitintooltwo/view.php?id=8342012>
 - Supporting Artefacts - <https://moodle.nottingham.ac.uk/mod/assign/view.php?id=8342013>
- Backup Submission (via MS Forms):
 - <https://forms.office.com/r/MzWJWBFT8N>
- You should use the following file formats for your final submission:
 - Dissertation - PDF
 - Project Artefacts - ZIP
- Your file must be named after your student id only
 - e.g. Dissertation - 2021XXXX.pdf
 - e.g. Project Artefacts - 2021XXXX.zip

Submission

Your dissertation should be less than 15,000 words or 40 pages.

Late Submissions

The standard university penalty applies - 5% per working day.

Dissertation Marking Criteria

Your supervisor will grade your dissertation based on the criteria provided below. Your dissertation will also be reviewed and marked by a panel of at least two other academic members of staff to ensure your marking is correct and fair.

- Knowledge and understanding
 - Breadth of knowledge on the subject area and knowledge of the chosen specific topic as the focus
 - Understanding of the (software development/research) methodologies / techniques / tools related to the project (e.g., specification, design, synthesis, etc.)
 - Quality & usage of sources
- Critical thinking skills
 - Extent of the justification of the method(s) (theoretical / experimental / analytical / numerical / design / objectives). E.g. related to theory / literature / standard

practices / performance requirements / specification

- Ability to describe relevant results
- Discussion and interpretation of result/ evaluation of software (own project): ability to sum up and interpret them, showing an awareness of limitations of own work.
- Discussion and interpretation of results/ evaluation of software in wider context: ability to interpret own results in wider context.
- Reflection on original plan
- Technical achievement
 - Quality of software (work/product/ implementation/ research)
 - Quality of supporting documentation (e.g., testing results, input/output data, user manual, comments etc.)
 - Attainment of agreed appropriate objectives and requirements
- Technical writing skills
 - Section headings
 - Visual elements (graphs, figures, tables): range of types of visual elements, quality and adequate presentation (labels, captions)
 - Degree of consistency of the formatting of the document (font size, references list, use of bold/italic, layout, spacing, etc.)
 - Structure of sentences and division of text into paragraphs
 - Use of in-text citations to support development of argument
 - Accuracy of the grammar
 - Typos
 - Style (use of technical vocabulary)
 - Length of report
- Professionalism
 - Ability to self-manage
 - Professional approach to project and time-management
 - Innovation and specific individual contributions
 - Demonstration video

More details on the marking criteria can be found in the project [dissertation marking rubric](#). This rubric provides a set of guidelines outlining the typical requirements of specific grade band for the dissertations. It is not necessary that a project exhibit all the criteria listed in each grade given below to fall within that band. The characteristics of each band are merely representative of that grade. The balance between various aspects of the particular work will be considered during assessment. The supervisor will provide a written feedback justifying the final mark.

Academic Conduct

All work submitted as part of your dissertation must be your own. The following guidelines apply:

Generative AI: All content submitted in your dissertation must be entirely your own work. Using generative AI tools to produce any written content in your dissertation is academic misconduct and will be treated accordingly.

Citation and Referencing:

- Ensure proper citation and paraphrasing throughout.
- Use direct quotes where needed and cite sources appropriately.
- All images, diagrams, and tables must be properly attributed.
- Any code or artefacts included must be your own, or clearly attributed if drawn from open-source or third-party sources.

In general, do not present someone else's work as your own. Use appropriate attribution throughout. If you are unsure about what is or isn't acceptable, consult your supervisor or review the University's [Academic Misconduct Policy](#).

Dissertation Structure (Guidance Only)

The following is a typical dissertation structure. However, this is for guidance only: depending on the type and specific aspects of your project, you may find it appropriate to structure your dissertation in a more or less different way. Discuss with your supervisor.

- **Demonstration video**
- **Title page** with a signed declaration that the dissertation is your own work. You are reminded of the University's guidelines on [Academic Integrity and Misconduct](#).
- **Abstract** giving a short overview of the work in your project.
- **Table of contents** giving page numbers for all major section headings.
- **Introduction** setting out the aims and objectives of your project, **explaining the overall intention of the project and specific steps that will be taken to achieve that intention**.**
- **Motivation** explaining the problem being solved and its importance or need for it.
- **Related work** explaining what your project does that is new or is better than existing work in the same field
- **Description of the work** explaining what your project is meant to achieve, how it is meant to function, e.g., perhaps even a functional specification for a software-oriented project
- **Methodology** describing the (theoretical/experimental/analytical/numerical/software development-based/research-based, etc.) methodologies/techniques/tools/algorithms/technologies/etc. that are relevant to the project topic justifying the choices made for the project, where possible with supporting evidence derived from the existing work.
- **Design** containing a comprehensive description of the design chosen, how it addresses the problem, and why it is designed the way it is
- **Implementation** containing a comprehensive description of the implementation of your software, including the language(s) and platform chosen, problems encountered, any changes made to the design as a result of the implementation, etc.
- **Evaluation** explaining how your software/approach was tested (using different datasets or in different environments), statistical evaluation of performance, results of user evaluation

questionnaires, etc.

- **Summary and Reflections** including a discussion of results in a wider context (considering other work).
 - **Project management covering** the tasks as a part of your work plan and progress as well as how time and resources are managed.
 - **Contributions and reflections** providing the details of your achievements and contributions including innovation, creativity and novelty (if there is any) as well as a personal reflection on the plan and your experience of the project (a critical appraisal of how the project went).
- **Bibliography** containing a *complete* list of books and other publications that are either explicitly referred to in the text, or which are recommended for further reading on the topic
- **Appendices**, e.g., User Manuals, supporting evidence for claims made in the main part of the dissertation (e.g. a copy of a user evaluation questionnaire), samples of test data, etc. Note that Appendices are optional

There is a maximum limit of 15,000 words without exceeding 40 pages (A4 sides) for the **main body** of the dissertation that will be submitted in PDF. Please note that the word limit does not apply to the cover page, references, or appendices. However, all other content within the document will contribute to the word count. There is no prescribed template, format, or referencing style that must be followed for this assignment. If you require guidance on these aspects, we recommend consulting your supervisor for advice.

Note: Your dissertation **should not exceed the word and page limits**. You do not have to use up your word limit to get a good grade; never 'pad out' your dissertation, this will only annoy the markers.

Getting Help

As always you may use the following mechanism to get help:

- Your Supervisor
- [Moodle Forum](#)

Extenuating Circumstances

If you are unable to complete or attend the specified deliverables on time due to a medical or personal/family issue, then you are required to obtain [Extenuating Circumstances](#). This process can be completed entirely online via Student Hub. For support on this, please email (thehub@notttingham.edu.cn). You should communicate your circumstances with your personal tutor (if you feel comfortable doing so).